Choosing one corridor for further research

Individual case memo | Jiayi Liu | November 7, 2026

Recommendation: Use the dashboard to build a shortlist, but do not choose the one priority corridor from its ranking alone. Afghanistan has the highest observed median cost. The evidence does not establish where further research would be most useful.

1. The person and the decision

Ana is a fictional project officer in IFAD's Financing Facility for Remittances (FFR). She has resources to investigate only one U.S.-origin remittance corridor first for opportunities to reduce costs. A poor choice could waste staff time and funding. Ana, her resource limit and this assignment are scenario assumptions, not a documented IFAD project.

2. Her real situation and alternatives

IFAD's FFR overview describes research into remittance flows, costs, regulations and market participants [1]. This supports Ana's role; it does not establish a procedure for choosing one U.S.-origin corridor. For this scenario, she needs both evidence of a price problem and a realistic opportunity to improve it.

Her alternatives include reviewing World Bank records directly, reading IFAD research, and consulting providers, country specialists and recipient communities. The dashboard organizes historical comparisons and service details, reducing the need to filter and summarize source records separately. It does not replace current local information. The World Bank describes its prices as snapshots and notes that some recipient-side charges are not tracked [2].

3. The app in use

Public app: https://project-c2b8ykvnwmkqm8o59iqymy.streamlit.app/

Executed selections: USA origin; all 42 receiving countries; 2025 Q3 only; USD 200; Cost & disclosure. Applied weights are two-thirds cost and one-third disclosure. Figure 1 shows these settings and the app's advice about missing community evidence.

The supplied public-app screenshots were captured on November 7, 2026. The five highest corridor cost medians and quote counts match the earlier local check (Figure 2). Provider-name counts below come from the separate prepared-CSV check; they are not displayed in that comparison screenshot.

Receiving country	Median total cost (%)	Eligible quotes	Provider names*
Afghanistan	8.875	6	3
Cuba	7.750	4	3
Bangladesh	7.525	24	9
Guyana	7.350	21	5
Armenia	6.950	16	5

*Recorded provider names, without consolidating related companies. Screenshots are excerpts, not the complete dataset. Details checked only in the prepared CSV are identified below.

4. Reading the result for her decision

Does the number measure what Ana cares about? Partly. Median cost identifies expensive sampled services, while Ana needs to know where research is most worthwhile. Cost is a stand-in for that broader goal (kind 3). All 1,010 selected quotes are marked transparent, so the disclosure term is zero throughout. The score ranks these corridors in the same order as their cost medians; it adds no evidence about affected families, research feasibility or likely benefits.

Who is in the rows, and who is not? Each row is a sampled service quote, not a customer, transaction or independent provider. The prepared-CSV check found six Afghanistan quotes: MoneyGram (3), Western Union (2) and Walmart2World (1). More quotes in Bangladesh do not establish more users or greater need. These summaries are not weighted by actual use and do not show all recipients' circumstances.

Are the services comparable? Amount and quarter are fixed, but service mixes differ. The CSV check found cash receiving for all six Afghanistan quotes; Bangladesh also includes bank accounts and mobile wallets. The public channel table separates Afghanistan into four Internet-only quotes and two counter-only quotes and warns about both small groups (Figure 4). This raises kind 7, "same mix?" It does not demonstrate Simpson's paradox or that switching channels causes savings.

What outside the data matters? Ana still needs current prices and services, corridor flows, recipient access, regulations, potential partners and realistic cost-reduction opportunities. The data used here are from 2025 Q3. The CSV check found five of Afghanistan's six pickup-location fields blank; that does not prove cash pickup is unavailable. The app already advises checking current prices and consulting the community (Figure 1). Community inputs are optional in Cost & disclosure; their absence is not a cost-calculation error.

For Afghanistan, the public fee/FX view shows a median fee of USD 7.745 and a median FX margin of 4.945% (Figure 3). These have different units, and separately calculated component medians cannot simply be added to reconstruct the 8.875% median total cost. Historical quotations can also omit some recipient charges [2].

5. The verdict: prove or break

Break for Ana's full decision. The app helps her form a shortlist and inspect historical costs, but it does not support choosing one priority corridor on its own. Organized comparisons are useful alongside source records and local consultation. The ranking must not be used as a complete resource-allocation rule or a description of today's prices. No single corridor is selected in this case; Ana's original decision remains unresolved.

CR-14: Show provider breadth beside corridor results. The request is recorded as **open** in the local team working copy of change-requests.md. It asks for distinct provider-name counts and the largest provider's count/share of eligible quotes beside each corridor and in exported briefings. Afghanistan would show three names and MoneyGram's 3/6 (50%). These must be labeled as sample composition, not market shares, with existing costs and scores unchanged.

This would help outreach researchers and advocacy writers as well as Ana judge the evidence. It would not supply the additional information needed for her one-corridor choice. At preparation, CR-14 was not implemented, committed or pushed.

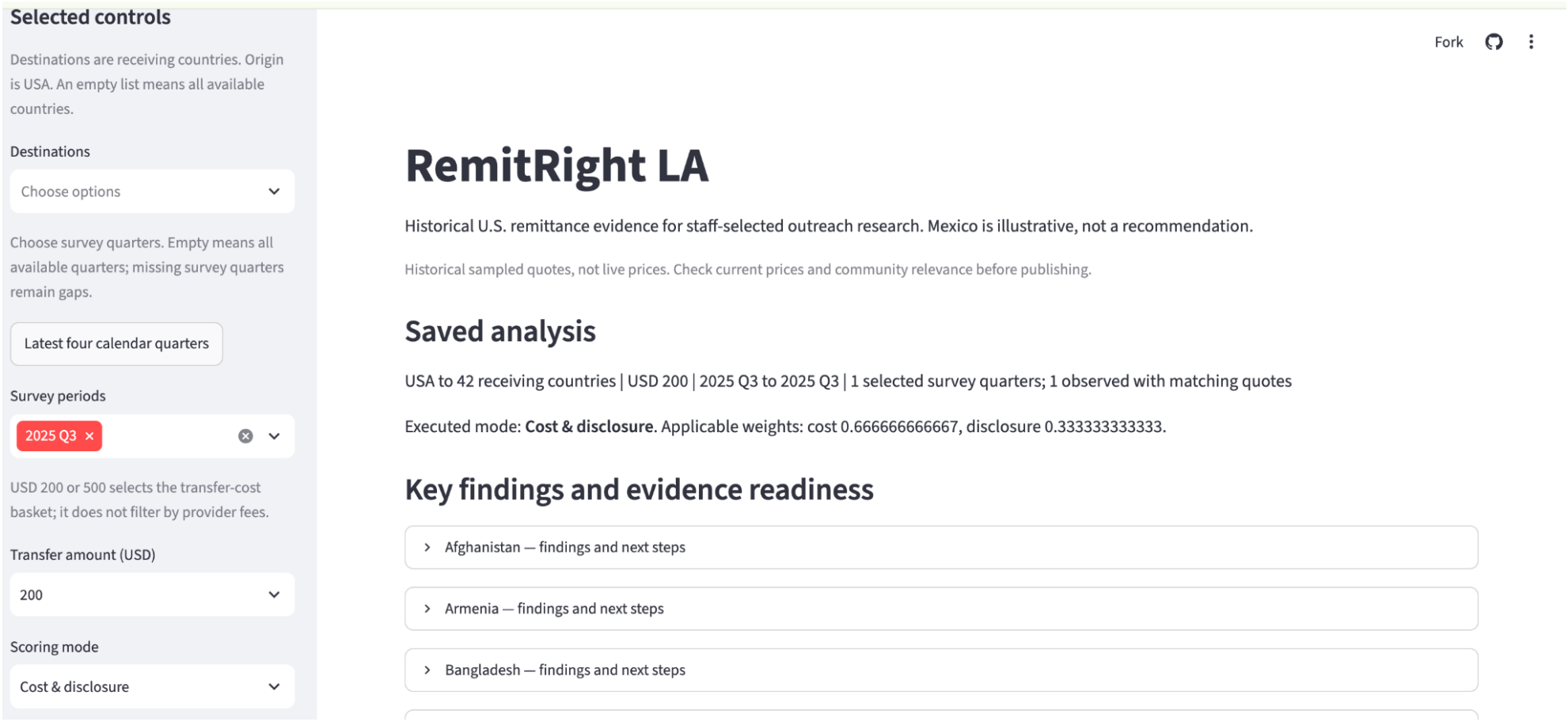
Sources

[1] IFAD. Financing Facility for Remittances. Official overview.
https://www.ifad.org/en/remittances/financing-facility-for-remittances

[2] World Bank. Remittance Prices Worldwide: Methodology.
https://remittanceprices.worldbank.org/methodology
Both official pages were checked on November 7, 2026. Additional provider-level details above come from the prepared-CSV check documented in the case working memo.

Figure 1. Executed settings and existing guidance

USA to all 42 receiving countries | 2025 Q3 | USD 200 | Cost & disclosure. The saved run shows the applied two-thirds/one-third weights. The lower excerpt is the Afghanistan guidance panel from the same run.



Afghanistan guidance excerpt: missing community inputs are optional in this mode; the app recommends current-price and community checks.

Median quoted cost 8.875% for USD 200; 6 eligible costs from 6 quotes. 0 quotes did not disclose the exchange rate.

Community evidence: Missing: rating, rationale, evidence source, evidence date.

Next step: Check current provider prices and discuss suitability with the community. Gather and document rating, rationale, evidence source, evidence date only if community-informed prioritization is needed; these inputs are optional for Cost & disclosure.

Figure 2. Highest corridor medians in the public run

Same executed settings as Figure 1. The view reports 1,010 eligible quotes and zero non-transparent quotes. This excerpt preserves the five highest corridor rows; it is not the complete 42-country table.

Matching quotes	Eligible cost quotes	Non-transparent quotes
1010	1010	0

Historical sampled services, not customers, transaction volumes, or market shares. Non-transparent and missing costs are excluded from cost medians, not from disclosure denominators.

Corridor comparison | Survey quarters | Channels | Fees and FX margins | Provider evidence

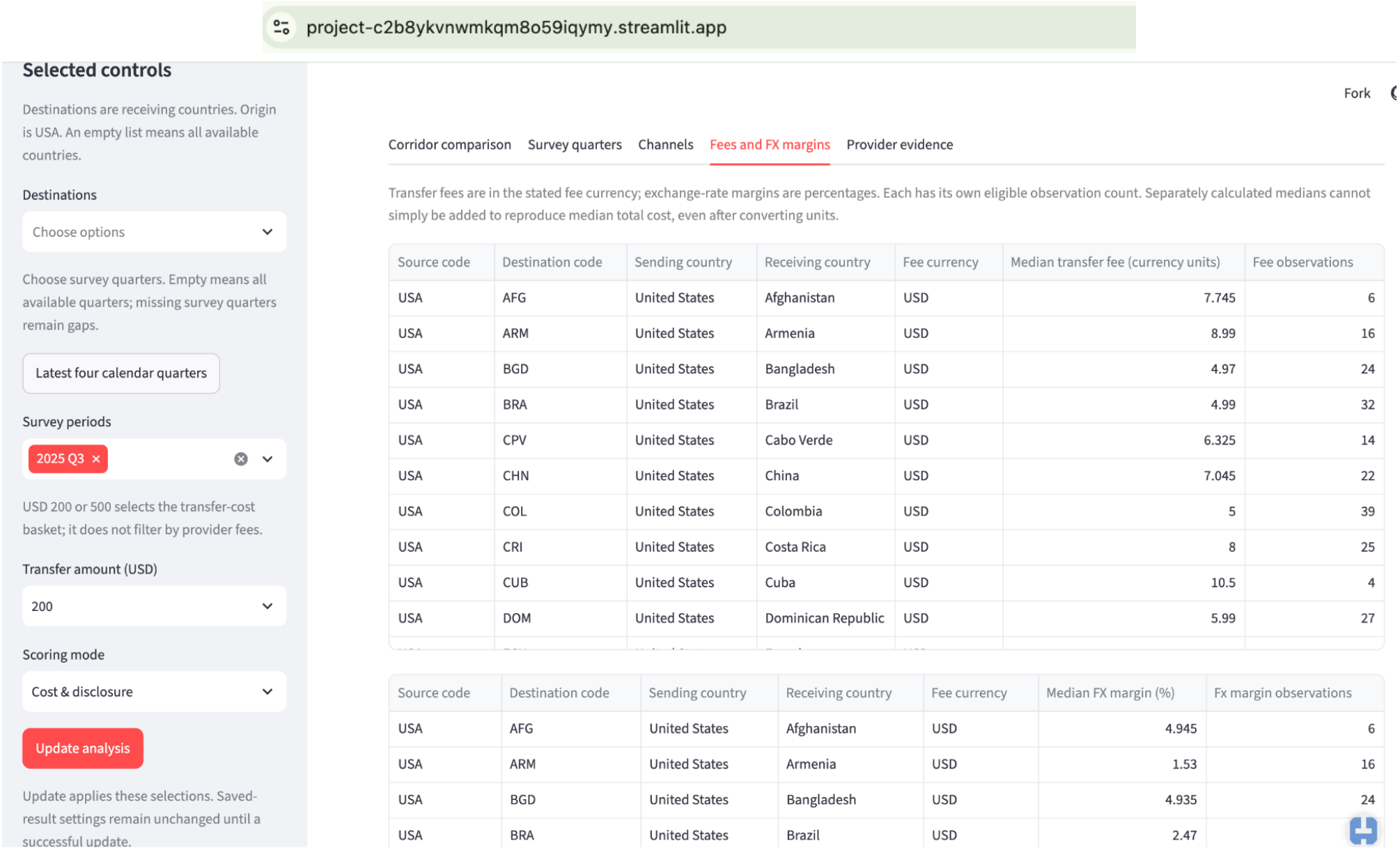
Pooled actual costs and counts come first. Missing scores do not erase descriptive price evidence.

Receiving country	Median total cost (%)	Eligible cost quotes	Flagged / total quotes (%)	Score	Scoring status
Afghanistan	8.875	6	0 / 6 (0.000000%)	0.666667	Available
Cuba	7.750	4	0 / 4 (0.000000%)	0.549571	Available
Bangladesh	7.525	24	0 / 24 (0.000000%)	0.526151	Available
Guyana	7.350	21	0 / 21 (0.000000%)	0.507937	Available
Armenia	6.950	16	0 / 16 (0.000000%)	0.466302	Available

Reading: Afghanistan is 8.875% from six quotes; Cuba is 7.750% from four; Bangladesh is 7.525% from 24. These are descriptive results for sampled services, not transaction-weighted market costs or a research-priority rule.

Figure 3. Public fee and FX evidence

Two excerpts from the same original screenshot: the public address bar and the app view. Selected controls remain visible. Afghanistan shows USD 7.745 median fee and 4.945% median FX margin, each from six observations; component medians are not additive.



Source code	Destination code	Sending country	Receiving country	Fee currency	Median transfer fee (currency units)	Fee observations
USA	AFG	United States	Afghanistan	USD	7.745	6
USA	ARM	United States	Armenia	USD	8.99	16
USA	BGD	United States	Bangladesh	USD	4.97	24
USA	BRA	United States	Brazil	USD	4.99	32
USA	CPV	United States	Cabo Verde	USD	6.325	14
USA	CHN	United States	China	USD	7.045	22
USA	COL	United States	Colombia	USD	5	39
USA	CRI	United States	Costa Rica	USD	8	25
USA	CUB	United States	Cuba	USD	10.5	4
USA	DOM	United States	Dominican Republic	USD	5.99	27

Source code	Destination code	Sending country	Receiving country	Fee currency	Median FX margin (%)	Fx margin observations
USA	AFG	United States	Afghanistan	USD	4.945	6
USA	ARM	United States	Armenia	USD	1.53	16
USA	BGD	United States	Bangladesh	USD	4.935	24
USA	BRA	United States	Brazil	USD	2.47	

Figure 4. Channel composition and sample-size warnings

Two excerpts from the same original screenshot, using the same 42-country run. Afghanistan has four Internet-only and two counter-only quotes. Both groups receive small-sample warnings. The displayed channel difference is descriptive, not guaranteed individual savings.

